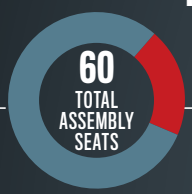
COVER STORY | MANIPUR

A BLOODY DIVIDE

The current bloodshed is the outcome of years of conflict between the state's ethnic groups over land, resources and identity

Text by KAUSHIK DEKA
Graphic by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY

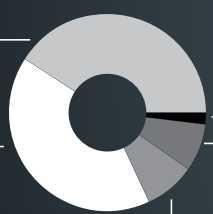
POLITICAL DIVIDE



40 In Imphal Valley, dominated by Meiteis

20 In the hills, dominated by Nagas and Kukis

RELIGIOUS DIVIDE



Hindu **41%**

Christian **41%**

Muslim **8.4%**

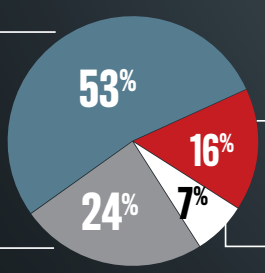
Others **1.8%**

Sanamahi **7.8%**

THE SWING

Between 1961 and 2011, the Hindu population, mostly Meiteis, declined from 62% to 41%, while that of Christians, mostly Nagas and Kukis, jumped from 19% to 41%

ETHNIC DIVIDE



MEITEI Mostly followers of Hinduism and Sanamahism

NAGA Mostly Christians

KUKI Mostly Christians

OTHERS

THE SWING

Between 2001 and 2011, the population of Imphal Valley, dominated by the Meiteis, grew by 16%, while it rose by 40% in the hills, inhabited by the Nagas and the Kukis

GEOGRAPHICAL DIVIDE

MIXED COMMUNITIES Jiribam

MEITEIS IN MAJORITY Imphal East, Imphal West, Thoubal, Bishnupur, and Kakching

KUKIS IN MAJORITY Churachandpur, Kangpokpi and Pherzawl

NAGAS IN MAJORITY Ukhrul, Kamjong, Tengnoupal, Senapati, Noney, Tamenglong and Chandel

FLASHPOINT

Meiteis account for 53% of the state's population but occupy only 11% of the geography. Nagas and Kukis, together 40%, are spread over nearly 90% of the area; most of it is forest

FACT CHECK

India's 'Gateway to the East' is the only feasible land route for trade between India and Myanmar, and other Southeast Asian countries

78% or 17,418 sq. km of Manipur's total geo-graphical area is under forest cover. The major forest produce includes timber, firewood, bamboo and cane